

more than a musical dilettante, writing songs while working as a civil servant in St. Petersburg. In 1830, he went to live in Western Europe, succumbing to the charm of Bellini and Donizetti operas in Italy and studying composition in Berlin. Returning to Russia in 1834, he embarked upon a patriotic opera, *A Life for the Czar*. Freshening up the current operatic conventions with references to Russian folk music, the opera was a huge success. His second opera, *Ruslan and Lyudmila* (1842), showed greater originality but received a cool reception when it premiered in St. Petersburg. Glinka again left for Western Europe, where he became interested in Spanish folk music. He died in Berlin in 1857. All subsequent Russian composers, including the members of the Mighty Handful, or The Five, acknowledged his influence.

KEY WORKS: *A Life for the Czar* (opera), 1836; *Ruslan and Lyudmila* (opera), 1842; *Kamarinskya* (symphonic poem), 1848; *Summer Night in Madrid* (overture), 1848